Now, a dedicated reader is an essential part of the design of an embedded-RFID application to interpret local tags. To better understand this, let us consider a vending machine. It's built-in reader can accept contactless payments from RFID cards, and can tag the dispensed items. Because these items have been tagged, the machine can intelligently keep a track of the contents of its inventory and can automatically order refills in case it is going to run out.

Embedded-RFID technology can also replace dangerous men in suits who throw you out of the casino after giving you a good thrashing when they find out that you have been cheating. Generally, cheating and sleight-of-hand movements when done by someone who considers himself an artist at it are difficult to detect, by human beings alone that is. With the appropriate set of data-capture tools, casino operators can sneakily monitor the behaviour of a player to detect if they are guilty of card-counting, can adjust promotions, and can minimise dealer errors which stack up huge losses for the casino. Seems far-fetched? We dare you to say that to International Game Technology and Progressive Gaming International. These two have jointly developed the table iD table-game-automation system which uses the combination of a series of RFID-chip-scanner modules and a software-based table manager. So how it works is that during play, chip readers at each position identify and also record each players bets. The iD system then studies players' betting patterns, records dealer activity, and assesses once an hour with a keen eye player's decisions. Information such as average bet and win/loss record is automatically updated and requires no user interaction.

The legend of RFID goes that you may enter a shopping mall, fill out your bag with whatever you have, and walk out without having to suffer the hassle of physically standing somewhere and paying. The RFID readers would simply scan the items and automatically deduct the required the amount from your bank account. While this definitely raises some questions, like for example –what if you place the item back into the shop-would you get back the money which was just deducted from your bank? Or what exactly would be the procedure if you do not have the required amount for the items? While we ponder these questions, we hope embedded-system designers are working on these things

Embedded systems powered driving?